

Requirement elicitation

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Summary: Business Analysis Elicitation

Elicitation is the process of conducting planned and structured interactions with stakeholders to gather information, identify needs, uncover opportunities, and understand challenges within a project. It is a core activity in business analysis because it helps ensure that stakeholder requirements, concerns, and perspectives are captured and considered.

Elicitation is important because it provides the information needed for informed decision-making, requirement gathering, and project planning. It also encourages stakeholder participation, promotes collaboration, and helps resolve conflicts or differing viewpoints. Without elicitation, critical information may remain undiscovered, leading to poor decisions, misunderstandings, and project delays. Therefore, elicitation should never be skipped, even when analysts believe they already understand the project, as stakeholders may offer valuable insights that were previously overlooked.

To conduct an effective elicitation session, business analysts first identify the relevant stakeholders who should participate. They then prepare thoughtful, open-ended questions to encourage meaningful discussion. During the session, the analyst acts as a facilitator, guiding conversations, maintaining focus, and ensuring objectives are achieved. Several techniques can be used during elicitation, including:

- **Interviews (one-on-one discussions)** to explore stakeholder needs and concerns in depth.
- **Observation** of stakeholder activities and system interactions.
- **Brainstorming** to encourage collaborative idea generation.
- **Focus groups** that bring diverse stakeholders together for discussion.
- **Questionnaires and surveys** to collect feedback from large groups efficiently.
- **Workshops** where stakeholders collaboratively define requirements and solutions.
- **Prototyping** to help stakeholders visualize and refine requirements.
- **Document analysis** by reviewing existing reports, manuals, and procedures.
- **Interface analysis** to understand interactions, dependencies, and integration requirements between systems.

By combining these techniques, business analysts can gather comprehensive information, gain deeper insights into stakeholder needs, and develop a thorough understanding of project requirements, ultimately contributing to project success.

Source: <https://share.percipio.com/cd/GEggFIPaL>